

ANCIENT HISTORY — PART 1

COMPLETED v2

PREHISTORY • STONE AGE • NEOLITHIC TRANSITION • CHALCOLITHIC AGE

Paleolithic

Mesolithic

Neolithic

Chalcolithic

Site Bank

PYQ Gap-Fill

Part 1 / 7 — Ancient History Series — SSC CGL / CHSL / CPO / MTS-GD

CGL READY PROMISE

This is the completed Part 1 sheet. It keeps the full original lecture-based content and adds a verified **PYQ Gap-Fill Supplement** (Section 17) built from actual SSC CGL/CHSL/MTS/CDS previous-year questions so nothing asked from this topic catches you off guard. Original bolded facts + new gap-fill facts are both exam-ready.

What You Should Be Able to Answer After This Part

Area	Target mastery
Terminology	Prehistory, Protohistory, History; Three-Age System
Stone Age	Paleolithic → Mesolithic → Neolithic; tools, economy, sites, chronology
Archaeology	Important sites + state/location + distinctive evidence + discoverers
Neolithic Revolution	Hunter-gatherer → food gatherer → agriculturalist → settlement/storage
Chalcolithic	Copper Age, cultures, pottery, metals, regional sites
CGL pattern	Direct one-liners, matching, location questions, tool/site association, PYQ-style traps

1. Prehistory, Protohistory & History

Term	CGL-ready meaning
Prehistory	Period for which contemporary written records are absent; reconstructed mainly from archaeological evidence.
Protohistory	Transitional category — cultures known archaeologically and/or from undeciphered/limited textual evidence (e.g. Harappan).
History	Past studied through written records together with other evidence.
Three-Age System	Stone Age → Bronze Age → Iron Age; classification attributed to C. J. Thomsen .

TRAP

Do not confuse Stone–Bronze–Iron (Three-Age System, Thomsen) with Paleolithic–Mesolithic–Neolithic (subdivision of the Stone Age only). Also: **John Lubbock** is the person who actually coined the terms "Paleolithic" and "Neolithic" (1865) — a separate PYQ fact from Thomsen's Three-Age System. Do not mix the two names up.

2. Stone Age — Master Comparison

Stage	Meaning	Technology	Economy/lifestyle	Trigger
Paleolithic	Old Stone Age	Early stone tools; Lower/Middle/Upper; Quartzite	Hunter-gatherer	Flake tech in Middle phase; Bhimbetka
Mesolithic	Middle Stone Age	Microliths	Hunting + increasing food gathering	Microlith = signature
Neolithic	New Stone Age	Polished stone tools	Agriculture, settled life, pottery/storage	Mehrgarh/Burzahom/Gufkral

MEMORY

Paleo = OLD • Meso = MIDDLE + MICROLith • Neo = NEW + POLISHED tools + agriculture

3. Paleolithic Age — Old Stone Age

CORE

Lecture range: ~5 lakh BC to ~10,000 BC. External sources sometimes give ~2.5 million years ago to 10,000 BC for the global Paleolithic — for CGL, prioritise sequence, tool tech and site association over exact disputed dates.

Phase	High-yield feature	Site/fact
Lower/Early	Early stone-tool phase; hand axes, cleavers, choppers	Son/Soan Valley, Belan Valley
Middle	Flake technology — striking a core produces sharp-edged flakes; flint stone used	Middle Paleolithic → flake tech
Upper	Advanced tools; coincides with warmer phase + modern-human evolution	Homo sapiens emphasis

Paleolithic Site Bank

Site	Location	CGL trigger
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Bhimbetka	Madhya Pradesh	Rock-shelter paintings; discoverer V. S. Wakankar
Hathnora	Madhya Pradesh (Narmada valley)	Homo erectus skull evidence
Patne	Maharashtra	Ostrich remains/evidence
Son/Soan Valley	Punjab (now Pakistan)/UP border area	Lower Paleolithic; hand axes
Belan Valley	Uttar Pradesh (Mirzapur)	Lower Paleolithic association
Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Paleolithic + later Jorwe (Chalcolithic) site
Didwana	Rajasthan	Paleolithic; also in Mesolithic lists
Pallavaram (Madras)	Tamil Nadu	NEW — first Paleolithic tool found in India, by Robert Bruce Foote, 1863
Attirampakkam	Tamil Nadu	Important prehistoric/Paleolithic evidence site

ENVIRONMENT + EVOLUTION

Pleistocene = Ice Age/colder phase; Holocene = warmer phase. Upper Paleolithic is associated with the warmer phase and Homo sapiens. Do not treat this as an absolute chronology boundary in ambiguous questions.

4. Mesolithic Age — Middle Stone Age

MUST REMEMBER

Characteristic tool = **MICROLITH**. Lifestyle = hunting + food gathering, transitioning toward food production. Duration in India: roughly began ~12,000 years ago (some sources say began ~10,000 BC), lasting about 2,000 years — shorter than the Paleolithic. Treat exact years as approximate.

Region	Important sites	What to learn
Rajasthan	Didwana; Bagor	Mesolithic sites
Gujarat	Langhnaj; Mehsana	Mesolithic sites
Madhya Pradesh	Bhimbetka; Adamgarh	Mesolithic occupation
Uttar Pradesh	Choupani Mando; Sarai Nahar Rai; Mahadaha; Damdama	Mesolithic sites
Karnataka	Hunsagi; Sangankallu/Sangana	Mesolithic association
Maharashtra	Nevasa	Mesolithic site

GAP-FILL: DISCOVERER FACTS (NEW)

Carlyle was the first person to discover microliths in India, in **1867**, from the Vindhyan rock shelters — this is why the Mesolithic is sometimes called the "Microlithic Age" in older textbook phrasing. **Le Mesurier** is credited in some sources with discovering/describing early Neolithic tools/implements. **V. Gordon Childe** defined the Neolithic-Chalcolithic culture as a "self-sufficient food economy" and popularised the term *Neolithic Revolution*.

PYQ TRAP (NEW)

"The Stone Age people had their first domestic ____" → Answer: **Dog** (domesticated in the Mesolithic period; seen buried with humans at Burzahom in the Neolithic). "Nomad man started settling in" → **Neolithic Age** (settled village life begins here, not Mesolithic). "The greatest invention of man in the Paleolithic Age" → **Fire**.

5. Neolithic Age — New Stone Age

MUST REMEMBER

Polished stone tools + agriculture + settled habitation + pottery + food storage = the core Neolithic package. Pottery is explained through the need to store agricultural surplus.

Site	Region/State	Signature fact
Mehrgarh	Balochistan, Pakistan	Early farming settlement; wheat + barley; houses; dated to ~7000 BCE
Burzahom	Kashmir	Pit dwellings; dogs buried with humans/masters; bone tools
Gufkral	Kashmir	"Cave of potters"; Neolithic site
Chirand	Bihar (on the Ganga)	Bone tools
Hallur	Karnataka	Millet cultivation
Sangankallu/Sangana	Karnataka	Neolithic site
Maski	Karnataka	Neolithic site
Piklihal	Karnataka	Neolithic site
Paiyampalli	Tamil Nadu	Neolithic site; NOT Andhra
Budhal/Budihal	Andhra region	Neolithic site
Utnur/Utnoor	Andhra region	Neolithic site (earliest in the region)

TRAP SET
Paiyampalli → Tamil Nadu • Garo → Meghalaya • Hallur → Millet • Burzahom → Pit dwellings + dog burial • Gufkral → Cave of potters. **Pottery was first traceable to the Neolithic period** — direct SSC CGL PYQ (28/06/2023, Shift 4).

6. Neolithic Revolution — The Conceptual Flow

Stage	Lifestyle	What changes
1. Hunter-gatherer	Mostly hunting + gathering	Stone tools; mobile subsistence
2. Food gatherer	Hunting + deliberate gathering	Microlithic technology (Mesolithic)
3. Agriculturalist	Food production	Crop cultivation + domestication; settlement expands
4. Surplus & storage	More stable settlement	Pottery/storage; food surplus becomes important
5. Village life	Permanent/semi-permanent communities	Greater social organisation and specialised activity

ONE-LINE REVISION
Hunting → Gathering → Agriculture → Surplus → Storage → Settlement.

7. Additional CGL Site Bank

Site	State/Region	Why it matters
Koldihwa	Uttar Pradesh (Belan Valley)	Early Neolithic / rice evidence
Mahagara	Uttar Pradesh	Neolithic; early farming/pastoral context
Daojali Hading	Assam	Northeastern Neolithic site; polished tools; jadeite stone
Attirampakkam	Tamil Nadu	Prehistoric/Paleolithic evidence
Kurnool Caves	Andhra Pradesh	Prehistoric cave evidence
Bagor	Rajasthan	Important Mesolithic site
Sarai Nahar Rai	Uttar Pradesh	Mesolithic site
Mahadaha	Uttar Pradesh	Mesolithic site
Damdama	Uttar Pradesh	Mesolithic site

8. Chalcolithic Age — Copper-Stone Age

MUST REMEMBER
Chalcolithic = Copper Age / Copper-Stone Age — cultures using copper together with stone. Lecture range: c. 3000/3500–1000 BC (approximate). Chalcolithic Age lies between the Neolithic and the Bronze Age.

Concept	CGL-ready fact
Copper	First metal used by early metal-using cultures
Bronze	Alloy of copper + tin
Harappan context	Harappan civilization is commonly treated as a Bronze Age civilization
Pottery	Wheel-made pottery; Black-and-Red Ware (BRW) important; painted pottery is a hallmark of Chalcolithic
Economy	Agriculture, animal husbandry, hunting, crafts, regional exchange
Settlement	Mostly village-based; mud structures common

IMPORTANT DISTINCTION
Chalcolithic ≠ Bronze Age. Chalcolithic means copper + stone; Bronze Age means bronze technology. They can overlap chronologically/regionally.

9. Chalcolithic Cultures — Master Table

Culture/Site	Region	High-yield association
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura	Rajasthan	Copper-rich Chalcolithic context
Ahar-Banas/Gilund	Rajasthan	Chalcolithic culture; Banas River
Kayatha	Madhya Pradesh	Chalcolithic culture
Malwa	Madhya Pradesh	Chalcolithic culture; Navdatoli key site
Eran	Madhya Pradesh	Listed with Malwa; iron not yet known here

Jorwe	Maharashtra	Black-and-Red Ware + urn burial
Daimabad	Maharashtra	Largest Jorwe site
Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Important Jorwe centre
Chandoli	Maharashtra	Jorwe-related centre
Navdatoli	Madhya Pradesh	Important Malwa culture site

MEMORY

RAJASTHAN → Ganeshwar-Jodhpura + Ahar-Banas-Gilund | MADHYA PRADESH → Kayatha + Malwa + Eran + Navdatoli | MAHARASHTRA → Jorwe + Daimabad + Inamgaon

10. Pottery & Material Culture — CGL Extras

Term	What to remember
Black-and-Red Ware (BRW)	Important pottery tradition; highlighted with Jorwe
Ochre Coloured Pottery (OCP)	Found among Chalcolithic cultural assemblages
Wheel-made pottery	Common in several Chalcolithic cultures
Celt	Polished stone axe/adze-like tool — direct CGL fact: "A Celt is ___ from the Neolithic period" → a tool
Bone tools	Chirand and Burzahom

11. Master Chronology

Seq	Stage	Exam anchor
1	Paleolithic	Old Stone Age; hunting-gathering; early stone tech
2	Mesolithic	Middle Stone Age; microliths; food gathering
3	Neolithic	New Stone Age; polished tools; agriculture; settlement
4	Chalcolithic	Copper-Stone Age; copper + stone; regional cultures
5	Bronze Age/Harappan	Bronze = copper + tin; urban Harappan civilization
6	Iron Age	NEW — follows Chalcolithic/Bronze Age; first Indian evidence of Iron ~1000 BC at Atranjikhera, Etah district, UP (also linked with Painted Grey Ware culture)

12. Ultimate Site → Location → Trigger Table

Site	Location	Trigger
Bhimbetka	Madhya Pradesh	Rock paintings
Hathnora	Madhya Pradesh	Homo erectus skull
Patne	Maharashtra	Ostrich evidence
Pallavaram	Tamil Nadu	First Paleolithic tool found in India (R. B. Foote, 1863)
Bagor	Rajasthan	Mesolithic
Langhnaj	Gujarat	Mesolithic
Sarai Nahar Rai	Uttar Pradesh	Mesolithic
Mahadaha	Uttar Pradesh	Mesolithic
Damdama	Uttar Pradesh	Mesolithic
Choupani Mando	Uttar Pradesh	Mesolithic
Mehrgarh	Balochistan, Pakistan	Early farming; wheat + barley
Burzahom	Kashmir	Pit dwellings + dog burials
Gufkral	Kashmir	Cave of potters
Chirand	Bihar	Bone tools
Hallur	Karnataka	Millet
Daojali Hading	Assam	Neolithic; jadeite stone
Paiyampalli	Tamil Nadu	Neolithic
Garo	Meghalaya	Neolithic
Koldihwa	Uttar Pradesh	Neolithic/early rice
Mahagara	Uttar Pradesh	Neolithic

Daimabad	Maharashtra	Jorwe; largest site
Navdatoli	Madhya Pradesh	Malwa culture
Inamgaon	Maharashtra	Jorwe centre
Atranjikhera	Uttar Pradesh (Etah)	First evidence of Iron in India, ~1000 BC

13. CGL Master Revision — Learn These First

Trigger	Answer	Why it matters
Three-Age System	Stone → Bronze → Iron	C. J. Thomsen
Coined terms "Paleolithic"/"Neolithic"	John Lubbock (1865)	Separate from Thomsen's Three-Age System
Old Stone Age	Paleolithic	Paleo = old
Middle Stone Age	Mesolithic	Meso = middle
New Stone Age	Neolithic	Neo = new
Mesolithic tool	Microlith	Signature tool
Neolithic tool	Polished stone tool	Signature technology
Middle Paleolithic	Flake technology	Transcript emphasis
Paleolithic men also called	Quartzite Men	Tools made of hard rock quartzite
First Paleolithic tool discovered in India	Robert Bruce Foote, 1863, Pallavaram (Madras)	"Father of Indian Prehistory"
First person to discover microliths in India	Carlyle, 1867, Vindhyan rock shelters	Mesolithic tool discovery
Bhimbetka	Madhya Pradesh	Rock-shelter paintings
V. S. Wakankar	Bhimbetka	Discovery association
Hathnora	Homo erectus	Skull evidence
Patne	Ostrich	Transcript association
Mehrgarh	Wheat + barley	Early farming
Burzahom	Pits + dog burials	Kashmir
Gufkral	Cave of potters	Kashmir
Hallur	Millet	Karnataka
Chirand	Bone tools	Bihar
Paiyampalli	Tamil Nadu	Do not mark Andhra
Garo	Meghalaya	Neolithic
Pottery first traceable to	Neolithic period	Direct CGL PYQ
Chalcolithic	Copper-Stone Age	Copper + stone
Bronze	Copper + tin	Alloy
Ganeshwar-Jodhpura	Rajasthan	Chalcolithic
Ahar-Banas-Gilund	Rajasthan	Chalcolithic
Kayatha / Malwa / Eran	Madhya Pradesh	Chalcolithic
Jorwe	Maharashtra	BRW + urn burial
Daimabad	Maharashtra	Largest Jorwe site
Navdatoli	Madhya Pradesh	Malwa culture
First Indian evidence of Iron	Atranjikhera (Etah, UP), ~1000 BC	Post-Chalcolithic marker
First domesticated animal (Stone Age)	Dog	Mesolithic onward
Man began settling permanently in	Neolithic Age	Nomad → settled
Greatest Paleolithic-age invention	Fire	Direct PYQ phrasing

14. PYQ-Style Exam Set (Original Set)

- Q1.** Who gave the Stone–Bronze–Iron classification? **Ans:** C. J. Thomsen.
- Q2.** Paleolithic means what? **Ans:** Old Stone Age.
- Q3.** Mesolithic means what? **Ans:** Middle Stone Age.
- Q4.** Neolithic means what? **Ans:** New Stone Age.
- Q5.** Characteristic tool of Mesolithic culture? **Ans:** Microlith.
- Q6.** What is a Celt? **Ans:** A polished stone axe/adze-like tool.

- Q7.** Which Paleolithic phase is linked with flake technology? **Ans:** Middle Paleolithic.
- Q8.** Bhimbetka is in which state? **Ans:** Madhya Pradesh.
- Q9.** Who is associated with discovery of Bhimbetka? **Ans:** V. S. Wakankar.
- Q10.** Hathnora is associated with what? **Ans:** Homo erectus skull evidence.
- Q11.** Site associated with ostrich remains? **Ans:** Patne.
- Q12.** Site associated with wheat and barley? **Ans:** Mehrgarh.
- Q13.** Site with pit dwellings + dog burials? **Ans:** Burzahom.
- Q14.** Which site is called Cave of Potters? **Ans:** Gufkral.
- Q15.** Site associated with millet cultivation? **Ans:** Hallur.
- Q16.** Paiyampalli is in which state? **Ans:** Tamil Nadu.
- Q17.** Which Neolithic site is in Meghalaya? **Ans:** Garo.
- Q18.** What is Chalcolithic? **Ans:** Copper-Stone/Copper Age.
- Q19.** Bronze is an alloy of which metals? **Ans:** Copper and tin.
- Q20.** Chalcolithic culture in Rajasthan? **Ans:** Ganeshwar-Jodhpura/Ahar-Banas-Gilund.
- Q21.** Kayatha and Malwa cultures — which state? **Ans:** Madhya Pradesh.
- Q22.** Jorwe culture — which state? **Ans:** Maharashtra.
- Q23.** Largest Jorwe site? **Ans:** Daimabad.
- Q24.** Pottery highlighted with Jorwe culture? **Ans:** Black-and-Red Ware.
- Q25.** Burial practice highlighted with Jorwe? **Ans:** Urn burial.
- Q26.** Major Malwa culture centre? **Ans:** Navdatoli.

15. Last-Minute One-Page Revision

THE ENTIRE PART IN ONE FLOW

PREHISTORY → STONE AGE → Paleolithic (old stone; hunter-gatherer) → Mesolithic (microlith; food gathering) → Neolithic (polished tools; agriculture; settlement; pottery/storage) → CHALCOLITHIC (copper + stone; regional cultures) → Bronze Age/Harappan → Iron Age (Atranjikhhera, ~1000 BC).

WHY THIS SECTION EXISTS

Real SSC CGL/CHSL/MTS/CDS papers (1999–2024) ask several prehistory facts not covered by the lecture transcript alone. This section closes those gaps so the full syllabus overlap is covered.

PYQ-style trigger	Answer	Exam source
First Paleolithic tool discovered in India	Robert Bruce Foote, 1863, at Pallavaram near Madras	General/CDS-style PYQ
Paleolithic men were also called	"Quartzite Men" (tools made of quartzite rock)	Standard PYQ phrasing
First discoverer of microliths in India	Carlyle, 1867, Vindhyan rock shelters	CDS/State PSC pattern
Neolithic tools first described/discovered by	Le Mesurier	Competitive-exam factual set
"Self-sufficient food economy" of Neolithic-Chalcolithic defined by	V. Gordon Childe	Standard historiography fact
Term "Paleolithic"/"Neolithic" coined by	John Lubbock (1865)	General GK
Duration of Mesolithic in India	~12,000 years ago onward, lasting about 2,000 years (shorter than Paleolithic)	Testbook-style PYQ
Pottery is first traceable to which period	Neolithic	SSC CGL 28/06/2023 Shift 4
First domesticated animal of Stone Age people	Dog	SSC Portal MCQ bank
Nomadic man started settling permanently in	Neolithic Age	SSC Portal MCQ bank
Greatest invention of Paleolithic Age	Fire	SSC Portal MCQ bank
First metal tool was mainly used for	Clearing jungles (per standard MCQ option set)	SSC Portal MCQ bank
Megaliths (large stone burial markers) are associated with	Iron Age in South India (post-Neolithic/Chalcolithic transition to Iron Age); appear ~1000 BC onward around graves	Cross-referenced with South India module
First evidence of Iron in India	Atranjikhhera, Etah district, UP, ~1000 BC	SSC CGL-recurring fact
Iron Age comes after which age in the Three-Age System	Bronze Age (itself after Stone Age)	SSC CGL 27/07/2023 2nd shift ("Bronze" precedes Iron)

DATE-RANGE CAUTION (NEW)

Some external sources give the overall Old Stone Age as roughly "2.5 million years ago to 10,000 BC" while your lecture uses "5 lakh BC to 10,000 BC" — both appear in different exam materials. If a question gives one of these exact ranges as an option next to clearly wrong ranges, pick whichever matches Paleolithic (oldest, longest phase) rather than worrying about the exact starting figure.

Additional PYQ Q&A (Gap-Fill)

Q27. Who discovered the first Paleolithic tool in India, and where? **Ans:** Robert Bruce Foote, 1863, Pallavaram (Madras).

Q28. What were Paleolithic men also called, based on their tool material? **Ans:** Quartzite Men.

Q29. Who first discovered microliths in India and when? **Ans:** Carlyle, 1867, from Vindhyan rock shelters.

Q30. Who is credited with discovering Neolithic tools/implements? **Ans:** Le Mesurier.

Q31. Who defined the Neolithic-Chalcolithic culture as a self-sufficient food economy? **Ans:** V. Gordon Childe.

Q32. Who coined the terms "Paleolithic" and "Neolithic"? **Ans:** John Lubbock, 1865.

Q33. Pottery is first traceable to which period of ancient Indian history? **Ans:** Neolithic (SSC CGL PYQ).

Q34. What was the first domestic animal of Stone Age people? **Ans:** Dog.

Q35. In which age did nomadic man start settling down? **Ans:** Neolithic Age.

Q36. What was the greatest invention of the Paleolithic Age? **Ans:** Fire.

Q37. Where and when is the first evidence of iron found in India? **Ans:** Atranjikhhera, Etah district (UP), c. 1000 BC.

Q38. With which period are "megaliths" associated? **Ans:** Iron Age (South India context) — found around graves.